☐ Exceeding Standard
☒ Meeting Standard
☐ Developing to Standard
☐ Below Standard

PETAL #2 - 7/10

9/11
Neel Jaiswal

Brent Staples wrote Black Men and Public Space as a reflection on incidents that occured for him starting in the 1970s. Staples acknowledges and adapts to the prejudice that people feel towards him in his life and he doesn't blame them for said prejudice, acknowledging their origins and reasons. He describes his first encounter similar to how a murderer would, calling the woman a "victim" and justifying her fear of "the youngish black man... both hands shoved into the pockets of a bulky military jacket" (Staples L5-6). (EV)

Staples uses juxtaposition via imagery to paint a picture of what the woman thinks, versus reality later on. Staples feels the exaggerated effects of the bad reputation of young Black men like himself, but doesn't feel irritated because of it. He changes his behavior, whistling classical melodies, to present the fear they feel. By tying together imagery and juxtaposition, Brent Staples acknowledges the judgement of people around him, and describes how he adapts to their preconcieved notions.

ooh - but make connection as sound again